



iTunes movie rental doubled

Just a couple of weeks after Apple made 4K an affordable option, the company has doubled the rental time to 48 hours. <http://dgit.in/iNoMovie>



CRISPR Breakthrough

CRISPR reveals clue to human embryo development, possibly reducing miscarriage risk in crucial initial pregnancy period. <http://dgit.in/LessMiscarriage>

MAN-MADE HOLES



Chand Baori: We have to start with India, obviously, and though this may not be the biggest or the deepest hole in India, it's the most impressive by far! 95 km from Jaipur is Abhaneri, where this magnificent hole can be found. It's got 3500 steps, and descends 100 feet down, and was built as a communal well in about 800 AD.



Bingham Canyon Mine: This is an open pit copper mine in Utah, US, and is also owned by the Rio Tinto group. It's a whopping 4 km wide (over 13,100 feet), and 970 m deep (3,182 feet). It's the largest hole ever dug by mankind – in terms of volume of stuff extracted from the hole.



Diavik Diamond Mine: Located in northern Canada, this diamond mine complex has several large holes that are easily viewable on Google Maps. It's not the largest, but it's one of the best looking mines in the summer. It's also one of the world's most remote mines, and is a feat of engineering, as it's pretty much dug into the middle of a lake! The deepest pit is about 600 feet deep, but underground operations mean that there's a lot happening that's not as visible as the pits.



Mirny Mine: Located in Siberia, Russia, the Mirny (or just 'Mir') diamond mine is a whopping 525 m deep (1722 feet), and has a diameter of 1,200 m (3,900 feet).



IceCube Neutrino Observatory: This large collections of narrow but deep holes near the south pole in Antarctica has been dug by scientists to get as far under the ice sheet as possible to try and detect neutrinos. The holes can go as deep as 2,450 m (8038 feet)!



Kola Superdeep Borehole: At just 9 inches in diameter, this is the smallest hole by far in this list. However, this Russian dug hole still holds the world record for being the deepest hole ever dug. While holes have been dug with longer drilling pipes, no hole has ever gone deeper straight down. The bottom of the Kola hole, 12,262 m (40,230 feet) is still the deepest artificial point on earth, and it's a record that's stood since 1989. It's far deeper inside the earth's crust than you fly above the earth in a commercial airline! It's been sealed since 1992 because the temperatures were a lot higher (180° C) than expected (100° C). Maybe hell is closer underground than we think!

We've obviously left out natural formations like the Grand Canyon, or the Marianas Trench, specifically the Challenger Deep, (10,916 m below sea level, or 35,814 feet), because we don't really consider them to be "holes". You could, however consider the Grand Canyon to be a very big, naturally eroded hole that was dug out by the Colorado river over a period of about 6 million years. How big a hole? About 446 km long, upto 29 km wide in some places and 1.8 km deep!

The real mind bender isn't the staggering size of the Grand Canyon, but the fact that it isn't actually the largest in the world. The title of "Grandest" canyon actually goes to the Yarlung Zangbo Canyon in Tibet. It's supposed to be 504 km long, it's deepest point is a whop-

ping 6 km, and averaged depth across the entire length is 2,268 m. Because it's under Chinese occupation, it's not the easiest place to visit, not just for tourists, but scientists as well. Plus the treacherous terrain of the Himalayas makes exploring the canyon extremely dangerous. It's why the Grand Canyon in Colorado is so popular, and so little is known about Yarlung Zangbo.

Have we missed any? Write in and tell us your favourite holes. And again, get your mind out of the gutter!